



TAMIL NADU

A Hub for Adventure Tourism

Blessed with a pristine coastline as well as rolling hills, Tamil Nadu has used these resources imaginatively to emerge as a leading adventure destination.





Tamil Nadu is home to abundant natural resources and scenic spots. These include a beautiful coastline that is nearly 1,100 kilometres long, the second-longest of any state in the country. This coast is home to several pristine beaches as well as the Gulf of Mannar Marine National Park. While the eastern part of the state is covered by pristine coastline, the north and western parts of Tamil Nadu are adorned by lush green mountain ranges. Tamil Nadu is the only state to have both the Western and Eastern Ghats, which converge at the Nilgiri Hills, part of the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve.

The beaches of Tamil Nadu offer many activities for adventure lovers, from surfing to scuba diving, snorkelling, boat rides and a variety of popular water sports.

An hour from Chennai, Kovalam Beach (also known as Covelong Beach) near the East Coast Road has emerged as a major hub for adventure tourism. The waves here are excellent for surfing and Kovalam is now home to an enthusiastic surfing community as well as surfing school. A popular surfing, music and yoga festival is also held here. In 2021, Kovalam Beach was awarded the prestigious Blue Flag certification by the Denmark Environment Agency for its green cover, cleanliness, visitor facilities and excellent management.

Further south along the coast, Rameswaram is another well-established hub for adventure tourism with activities like snorkelling, glass-bottom boat rides, kayaking, jet-skiing, stand-up boarding, windsurfing and coral watching. You can also go scuba diving in these crystal-clear waters with PADI-certified diving professionals.

Inland, the hill tracts of Tamil Nadu are happy hiking grounds for campers, trekkers and mountaineers alike. The popular hill stations of the state like Ooty, Coonoor, Yelagiri, Kodaikanal, Kotagiri, Yercaud, Topslip, Kolli Hills and so on have emerged as hubs for a variety of adventure tourism experiences. Apart from the more conventional options like camping in scenic settings and trekking on popular routes, there are activities like zip-lining and glamping as well. For instance, you can seek an enthralling sky-cycling experience at Ooty or get an opportunity to enter the marine world through scuba diving at Rameswaram. Lying 10 kilometres from Ooty is Doddabetta—the highest peak in Tamil Nadu—at a height of 2,637 metres. It also happens to be an easy peak to climb and the trek to the top takes you on an extremely scenic route.

In 2022, the first Tamil Nadu International Kite Festival was organised in Mamallapuram. Bikers festivals and rural sports are being popularised in the state. Besides, events like the just-concluded International Balloon Festival in Pollachi are sure to give adventure tourism in Tamil Nadu a big boost. On the whole, Tamil Nadu offers diverse interesting experiences for thrill seekers and adventure lovers.



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